

Robin Fischer

PhD Researcher, University of Economics and Business (WU), Vienna

Energy Transition • Machine Learning • Technological Change

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I study the economics of the energy transition and how firms adapt to it. My work spans identifying who wins the competitive landscape of tomorrow to building probabilistic models that uncover why.

Education

PhD in Economics, University of Economics and Business (WU), Vienna	2024 – present
Advisor: Anton Pichler	
M.Sc. in Economics, Durham University, St. Chads College	2023 – 2024
M.Sc. in Economics, University of Cologne	2022 – 2024
B.A. in Mathematics and Philosophy, TU Braunschweig	2016 – 2022

Research Experience

Complexity Science Hub (CSH), Vienna	2024
<i>Researcher Intern — Green Transition & Climate Change</i> (Host: Anton Pichler)	
Developed ML clustering models for firm technology portfolios using global power sector panel data.	

CoronaNet Project, LMU Munich	2020 – 2022
<i>Research Assistant</i>	
Collected government COVID-19 policy response data. Acknowledged in Cheng et al., Nature Human Behaviour (2020).	

Professional Experience

Federation of German Industries (BDI), Berlin	2022
<i>Research Assistant</i>	
Analysed the Ukraine war's economic impact on German industry sectors.	
Daimler AG, Stuttgart	2020 – 2021
<i>Data Analyst (Market Research)</i>	
Designed a Python geocoding algorithm for global supply-chain mapping.	

Awards & Funding

Excellent Teaching Award, WU Vienna	2026
Academic Development Fund, Durham University	2023
Study Scholarship, Studienstiftung des deutschen Volkes	2016 – 2024
Travel Scholarship, Stiftung für Studienreise (zis)	2015
Studienkompass Scholarship, Stiftung der Deutschen Wirtschaft	2011 – 2014

Working Papers

- **The Widening Profitability Gap between Renewable and Fossil Power Firms in Europe**
Robin Fischer, Anton Pichler
Working Paper, 2025 [[Preprint](#)]
Cited in a motion submitted to the [German Bundestag](#) (Drucksache 21/5484) on windfall profits in the fossil energy sector, April 2026.

Selected Talks

- [The 2026 Climate and Energy Finance Conference](#) May 2026
- [ETH Energy Summer School 2025](#) August 2025
- [The 15th Bayesian Econometrics Workshop](#) June 2025

Academic Service

Reviewing

Energy and Climate Change (Elsevier, [ISSN 2666-2787](#)) 2025

zis Foundation

2019 – present

Steering Committee Member & Mentor

Evaluate international research-travel proposals; mentor participants aged 16–21.

Technical Skills

Machine Learning	PyTorch, scikit-learn, XGBoost
Econometrics	Bayesian econometrics, panel methods, causal inference
Programming	Python, R, Git
Languages	German (native), English (C1), Spanish (B1)